

Bombers, Attack Aircraft, and Trainers

With Cold War tension at its peak, World War II experiments with jet engines and supersonic wing profiles were exploited to produce some truly impressive aircraft, such as the Avro Vulcan with its electrohydraulic powered flying controls, the ultra-high-altitude Canberra, and the double-delta-wing Saab Draken. The Soviets lagged behind at first, finding that only turboprop engines had the range to reach the US and return.

▷ **Lockheed T33 Shooting Star 1950**

Origin	USA
Engine	5,400 lb (2,466 kg) thrust Allison J33-A-35 turbojet
Top speed	600 mph (965 km/h)

First flown in 1948, used by air forces worldwide, and still in service in Bolivia, 6,557 of this US two-seat jet trainer were built. This is a stretched version of the US's first jet fighter, the F-80 Shooting Star.



▷ **English Electric Canberra 1951**

Origin	UK
Engine	2 x 7,400 lb (3,352 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce Avon 109 turbojet
Top speed	580 mph (933 km/h)

Britain's first jet bomber, the Canberra, first flew in 1949. It was highly adaptable and served with many air forces worldwide, on both sides in some wars. It set a world altitude record in 1957.



▷ **Vickers Valiant 1953**

Origin	UK
Engine	4 x 9,500 lb (4,304 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce Avon RA28 Mk 204 turbojet
Top speed	567 mph (913 km/h)

First of the RAF's nuclear force V-bombers, the swept-wing Valiant high-level strategic bomber was soon reduced to support roles, such as refueling and reconnaissance, and was retired in 1965.



△ **Myasishchev M-4 "Bison" 1954**

Origin	USSR
Engine	4 x 19,280 lb (8,734 kg) thrust Mikulin AM-3A turbojet
Top speed	588 mph (947 km/h)

The Soviet Union's first strategic jet bomber had sufficient range to attack North America, although not to return home. It was steadily uprated, but only 93 were built and none saw use in combat.



△ **Fokker 4 S.11 "instructor" 1950**

Origin	Netherlands
Engine	190 hp Lycoming O-435 A air-cooled flat-8
Top Speed	130 mph (209 km/h)

This tandem-seat military trainer was developed by Fokker immediately after WWII and was adopted by air forces from South America to Israel. It was also built in Italy and Brazil.



◁ **Percival Pembroke 1952**

Origin	UK
Engine	2 x 540 hp Alvis Leonides Mk 127 supercharged air-cooled 9-cylinder radial
Top speed	186 mph (299 km/h)

A light military transport, with a longer wing than its civil counterpart to increase its load capacity, the Pembroke served with the RAF until 1988; 128 were built, some serving in Europe and Africa.